

The Netherlands: Provincial flags

Except for South Holland and North Brabant, all the Dutch provincial flags are modern creations.



DRENTHÉ

White and red are the colors of the Archbishops of Utrecht, former rulers of Drenthe. The black castle and stars recall the uprising of Coevorden against the archbishop.



FRIESLAND

The flag is based on that of the 15th century kings of Friesland. The colors are those of the Dutch flag. The stripes and flowers represent the seven districts of Friesland.



GRONINGEN

The flag, adopted in 1950, combines green and white from the town of Groningen, surrounded by red, white, and blue of Ommeland, reflecting the town's position.



NORTH BRABANT

The design, adopted in 1959, originated in Antwerp where red and white checked coats of arms were popular. It was associated with the area from the 17th century.



FLEVOLAND

Blue is for the Lake IJssel from which the province was reclaimed. Green is for vegetation and yellow for the cornfields. The lily recalls Lely, the engineer of the reclamation project.



GELDERLAND

In 1371, the dukedoms of Gelre and Gulik were united and combined their arms. The new arms was blue, yellow, and black, the colors which appear in the flag, hoisted in 1953.



LIMBURG

The red lion is from the arms of Limburg. White and yellow are from local coats of arms, while the narrow blue stripe is for the Maas River which crosses the province.



NORTH HOLLAND

Adopted in 1958, this flag unites the colors of Holland; yellow and red, with blue and yellow of West Friesland. Yellow, the common color, is placed at the top.